

CSS Text Effects

Complete Guide with Interactive Demos & Code Examples

1. Text Shadow

The text-shadow property adds one or more shadows behind text. Syntax: **text-shadow: offset-x offset-y blur-radius color;**

Simple Shadow

Subtle shadow effect

```
text-shadow: 2px 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.3);
```

Multiple Shadows (3D Effect)

Layered shadows

```
text-shadow: 3px 3px 0px #e74c3c, 6px 6px 0px #3498db, 9px 9px 15px rgba(0,0,0,0.2);
```

Glowing Text

Neon glow

```
text-shadow: 0 0 10px #3498db, 0 0 20px #2980b9, 0 0 30px #1a5276;
```

2. Text Stroke & Fill

Create outline text or colored strokes using **-webkit-text-stroke** and gradient fills.

Text Stroke (Outline)

Outline text

```
-webkit-text-fill-color: transparent; -webkit-text-stroke: 1.5px #2c3e50;
```

Colored Stroke

Bold stroke

```
-webkit-text-fill-color: #ecf0f1; -webkit-text-stroke: 2px #e74c3c;
```

Gradient Text Fill

Rainbow gradient

```
background: linear-gradient(45deg, #3498db, #e74c3c, #2ecc71); -webkit-background-clip: text; -webkit-text-fill-color: transparent; background-clip: text;
```

3. Letter & Word Spacing

Control spacing between characters and words for visual emphasis.

Wide Letter Spacing

SPREAD OUT TEXT

```
letter-spacing: 3px; text-transform: uppercase;
```

Tight Letter Spacing

Compressed text

```
letter-spacing: -1px;
```

Word Spacing

Words far apart

```
word-spacing: 15px;
```

4. Text Transform

Change text case without modifying the HTML content.

Uppercase

CONVERT TO UPPERCASE

```
text-transform: uppercase;
```

Capitalize

Capitalize Each Word

```
text-transform: capitalize;
```

Lowercase

convert to lowercase

```
text-transform: lowercase;
```

5. Text Decoration

Add underlines, overlines, and line-through with advanced styling options.

Underline with Color & Offset

Colored underline

```
text-decoration: underline; text-decoration-color: #e74c3c; text-decoration-thickness: 3px; text-underline-offset: 5px;
```

Overline Effect

Text with overline

```
text-decoration: overline; text-decoration-color: #3498db; text-decoration-thickness: 2px;
```

Line Through

Strikethrough text

```
text-decoration: line-through; text-decoration-color: #9b59b6; text-decoration-thickness: 2px;
```

Wavy Underline

Wavy decoration

```
text-decoration: underline wavy #3498db; text-decoration-thickness: 2px; text-underline-offset: 5px;
```

6. Combination Effects

Combine multiple properties for stunning visual impact.

3D Layered Text

3D EFFECT

```
font-weight: bold; letter-spacing: 2px; text-transform: uppercase; text-shadow: 3px 3px 0 #e74c3c, 6px 6px 0 #3498db;
```

Animated Gradient Text

Rainbow Mix

```
background: linear-gradient(45deg, #ff6b6b, #ffd93d, #6bcf7f, #4d96ff); -webkit-background-clip: text; -webkit-text-fill-color: transparent; background-clip: text; font-weight: 800;
```

7. Font Properties

Fine-tune text appearance with font-weight, font-style, and variants.

Font Weight: Light (300)

Thin, delicate text

```
font-weight: 300;
```

Font Weight: Bold (700)

Heavy, bold text

```
font-weight: 700;
```

Font Style: Italic

Slanted italic text

```
font-style: italic;
```

Font Variant: Small Caps

SMALL CAPITALS

```
font-variant: small-caps;
```

8. Text Alignment & Indent

Control text positioning and spacing within containers.

Center Aligned

Centered text

```
text-align: center;
```

First Line Indent

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua.

```
text-indent: 30px;
```

9. CSS Text Properties Reference

Property	Values	Example
text-shadow	offset-x offset-y blur-radius color	2px 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.3)
letter-spacing	px, em, or normal	2px or -1px
word-spacing	px, em, or normal	10px
text-transform	uppercase, lowercase, capitalize, none	uppercase
text-decoration	underline, overline, line-through, none	underline wavy #3498db
text-align	left, right, center, justify	center
font-weight	normal, bold, 100-900	700
font-style	normal, italic, oblique	italic
-webkit-text-stroke	width color	2px #2c3e50
text-indent	px, em, or percentage	30px

10. Tips & Best Practices

Performance Tip: Use text-shadow sparingly on large text blocks, as multiple shadows can impact performance. Test on mobile devices.

Browser Support: -webkit- prefixed properties like -webkit-text-stroke work best in Chrome, Safari, and Edge. Use fallbacks for Firefox.

Accessibility: Ensure sufficient contrast between text and background. Avoid pure white text on light backgrounds or pure black on dark backgrounds.

Readability: Combine effects sparingly. Too many effects can make text difficult to read. Keep effects functional and beautiful.

Common Combinations:

- **Headers:** Combine text-shadow + letter-spacing + font-weight for impact
- **Emphasis:** Use text-decoration with custom colors and thickness
- **Branding:** Gradient text + font variations create memorable brand typography
- **Readability:** Increase letter-spacing and line-height for long-form content